

INTEROFFICE COMMUNICATION
San Mateo Police Department
Support Services Division

DATE: January 20, 2022

TO: Captain David Peruzzaro

FROM: Lieutenant Todd Mefford

RE: Summary of Quarterly Audit of SMPD 'End-User' ALPR Data for Q4, 2021

Introduction

Per SMPD Standard Operating Procedure 205, our Department conducts quarterly audits of our 'End-User' data to ensure our employees are reviewing data in a manner consistent with policy and procedure. The data reviewed is generated and provided by the Northern California Regional Intelligence Center (NCRIC) and the Flock Platform Portal as they house data for the respective platforms. The results of these audits are summarized and presented to the Support Services Captain for review and later for retention by the Support Services Division.

Quarter 3, 2021

PIPs / BOSS (July, August & September)

Although the contract with Neology has ended, we continue to utilize their ALPR hardware in our vehicles. Two of the three in-car systems are functional, and we still have the ability to log in and collect ALPR data via the PIPs cameras. We continue to upload this data into NCRIC via BOSS4 software. The following are the current end user data for the PIPs/BOSS queries from the NCRIC. ALPR plate reads are continuing to decrease, as anticipated, as we move away from this technology. 263,227 reads in Q2 and 199,256 reads now in Q3.

Audit Focus	Q3/2021	Quarterly Average
Number of searches	45	99
Number of searches with required criteria (as %)	100%	99.6%
Case numbers listed	45	83
Non-case numbers listed	10	19
(Reasons for search)		
Missing/Amber/Silver Alert	0	1
Criminal or Arrest	11	32
Special Event	0	0
Stolen or Wanted	34	23
Violent Crime	Unk	7

Quarter 3, 2021

Flock Safety (July, August & September)

This is the second complete audit of the Flock data since going online in February 2021. This audit includes a full sampling of data compiled between the months of July, August and September 2021 (Q3). The “Number of Searches” indicate searches of a license plate against a particular database; for instance, when an officer queries a plate, it searches NCIC, SVS, and other municipalities where we have access to their ALPR data. Single plate query appears as numerous searches because it is searching the individual databases, hence the high “Number of Searches.” As suspected, the Flock system is utilized often and had become a vital crimefighting tool. Last quarter’s usage was up 64% from the previous quarter and end-usage jumped another 49.95% this quarter.

There was a high number of entries for Flock that list “test” as the reason for query. This is due to the continued effort to keep the cameras calibrated and troubleshoot as problems are identified. In August, we learned that 11 of 22 of our Flock cameras were malfunctioning, and were not collecting data during the nighttime hours. The issue was the infrared system in the camera itself; those cameras were replaced on 10/18.

Audit Focus	Q3/2021	Quarterly Average
Number of searches	8,924	4,510
Number of searches with required criteria (as %)	100%	99.5%
Case numbers listed	5,875	4,777
Non-case numbers listed	3,049	1,939

Analysis and Conclusion

Our Department ‘End-user’ activity during the time period was consistent with Department policy and procedure. Our staff used this technology platform above normal usage rates, which is reasonable given the types of investigations they were conducting. No additional efforts are recommended.